PROJECT REPORT

CSE0001 -Digital Literacy

Name: Aryan Narayan Thakur
Reg. No: 25BAI10285

Introduction

This project report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course, a one-credit pass/fail subject designed for first-year B.Tech students across all branches at VIT Bhopal University. The project is structured around a real-world scenario in which I act as a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for helping my peers navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and effectively.

The portfolio consists of five tasks, each mapped to one module of the course. The tasks cover creating a digital literacy awareness infographic, building a professional student digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional email communication, and researching cybercrime awareness. All work has been organised in a GitHub repository and is documented in this report. This project required no prior coding knowledge — every tool used is free and browser-based, making it accessible to all students regardless of technical background.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module 1 |

For Task 1, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using Canva, a free browser-based design tool that requires no prior design experience. Canva provided ready-made templates, icons, and colour themes that made it easy to organise information in a visually appealing and structured way without requiring any coding or graphic design skills.

My infographic covers four key topics from the Digital Literacy course — what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, and professional online presence. The first section defines digital literacy as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information responsibly using digital technologies. The second section lists essential tools such as GitHub, Google Drive, Canva, HackerRank, LinkedIn, and Kaggle along with their specific uses for students. The third section addresses safe internet habits such as using strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, and being aware of UPI fraud. The fourth section explains why building a clean and consistent professional presence on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub from the first year is crucial for future career opportunities.

One thing I found particularly interesting while making this infographic was realising how much of digital literacy goes beyond simply using a phone or a laptop. It includes awareness, critical thinking, responsibility, and professional communication — skills I had not previously associated with the word ‘digital.’ Organising these ideas into a single visual page also helped me understand how interconnected these topics are.

Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Digital Literacy – Defined

Digital literacy is the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies — responsibly, safely, and effectively. It goes beyond just knowing how to use a smartphone or laptop. It means understanding how the internet works, how to protect your identity online, how to communicate professionally in digital spaces, and how to use digital tools to learn, collaborate, and build your future career.

Safe Internet Practices:

Staying safe online requires awareness, good habits, and quick action when something feels wrong. Every student should use a strong, unique password for each account and enable Two-Factor Authentication on important platforms like Google, GitHub, and their college email. Never click on suspicious links received via SMS, WhatsApp, or email — even if they appear to come from a known contact. One of the most common scams targeting college students in India is UPI fraud, where attackers trick victims into entering their PIN by claiming it is needed to receive money. Remember that you never need to enter your UPI PIN to receive a payment — a request always means money leaves your account. Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking or sensitive logins, keep your apps updated, and if you ever face cybercrime, report it immediately at cybercrime.gov.in or by calling the National Cyber Crime Helpline at 1930.

Professional Online Presence:

A professional online presence means having clean, complete, and consistent profiles on platforms where employers, internship coordinators, and the academic community actively look. It starts with a GitHub profile that showcases your projects and code, a LinkedIn profile that clearly states your education, skills, and career goals, and a Kaggle account for data-related work. Your profiles should use your real name, a professional photo if possible, and your college email address. What you post on social media also matters — future employers and internship panels do search your name online, and a single inappropriate post can create a lasting negative impression. Building your professional presence in your first year gives you a four-year head start. Each project you complete, each certificate you earn, and each connection you make online adds up to a digital reputation that speaks for you even before you walk into an interview room.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Module 2 |

For Task 2, I set up accounts on three professional digital platforms — GitHub, Kaggle, and Stack Overflow — as part of building my foundational student digital portfolio.

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform used by developers and students worldwide to store projects, collaborate on code, and showcase technical work publicly. I created a profile README repository, which is a special repository named after my username, and added my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn during my B.Tech programme. Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning where students and professionals practice on real datasets, participate in competitions, and share notebooks with the global community. I created an account to explore datasets and get familiar with the platform before my higher semesters. Stack Overflow is the world's largest developer question-and-answer community, where programmers ask and answer technical questions across every programming language and framework. I created an account so that I can actively use the platform to look up solutions and, over time, contribute answers as my skills develop.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to push all my academic projects and lab work so that my coding journey is documented and publicly visible. Kaggle will serve as a learning ground for data analysis and machine learning as I progress into higher semesters. Stack Overflow will be my go-to resource whenever I face technical problems, and I intend to gradually build my reputation on the platform by answering questions in areas I become confident in. Starting these profiles now, even at a minimal level, gives me a four-year head start in building a professional digital identity.

Aryanthakur-08 / README.md

Aryanthakur-08 Revise README with personal details and learning goals 1cff73e · now History

Preview Code Blame 22 lines (16 loc) · 1.06 KB Raw

Hi there, I'm Aryan Naryan Thakur! 👋

About Me

- **Branch:** B.Tech Engineering
- **Year:** First Year (Batch of 2025)
- **Institution:** VIT Bhopal University

Professional Goals & Interests

- **Technical Focus:** I am actively practicing Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) using **Java** and **Python.**
- **Competitive Programming:** I'm currently a beginner on **Codeforces** and enjoy solving complex logic problems.
- **The Big Picture:** I am passionate about the intersection of AI and human resources. My goal is to build an AI-based recruiting platform tailored for the Indian market that streamlines how talent is discovered and hired.

My Learning Goal for this Year

"In my first year, I hope to build a rock-solid foundation in computational logic and AI integration so that I can begin developing scalable solutions for real-world recruitment challenges."

Connect with Me

- https://www.hackerrank.com/profile/aryanthakur6780

"It's not who I am underneath, but what I do that defines me." — *Bruce Wayne*

kaggle.com/aryannarayanthakur

All Bookmarks

kaggle

Search

Create

Home

Competitions

Datasets

Models

Benchmarks

Game Arena

Code

Discussions

Learn

More

Your Work

Edit your public profile

Settings Your Work Progression

aryannarayanthakur

Aryan Narayan Thakur

Joined 13 seconds ago · last seen in the past day

About

Bio

Follow

Stack Overflow Products Try new site BETA user:32550379

Home NEW

Questions

AI Assist

Tags

Saves

Challenges

Chat

Articles

Users

Companies

COLLECTIVES

Communities for your favorite technologies.

Explore all Collectives

STACK INTERNAL

Stack Overflow for Teams is now called Stack Internal. Bring the best of human

Edit profile Network profile

Aryan Thakur

Member since today Last seen this week Visited 1 day, 1 consecutive

Profile Activity Saves Settings

Summary

Answers

Questions

Tags

Articles

Badges

Following

Bounties

Reputation

All actions

Responses

Votes

Summary

Reputation is how the community thanks you

When users upvote your helpful posts, you'll earn reputation and unlock new privileges.

Learn more about reputation and privileges

Earn badges for helpful actions

Badges are bits of digital flair that you get when you participate in especially helpful ways.

Take the Tour and earn your first badge

Measure your impact

Your posts and helpful actions here help hundreds or thousands of people searching for help.

Answers Score Activity Newest

Questions Score Activity Newest Views

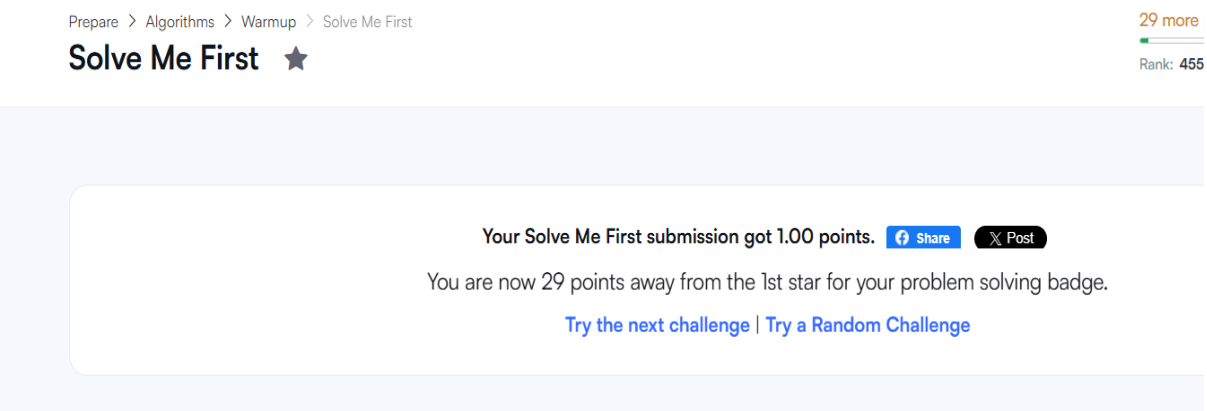
Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Module 3 | Marks: 20

Task 3 required me to explore two categories of digital tools that are essential for any engineering student — coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools. This task helped me get hands-on experience with real platforms rather than just reading about them.

For Part A, I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level coding challenge. HackerRank is a competitive programming platform where students can practice coding problems across languages like Python, Java, and C++, and earn skill badges that can be shared on their profiles. Completing even a simple challenge made me realise that consistent daily practice on such platforms is one of the most effective ways to improve problem-solving skills before placements and internship interviews.

For Part B, I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' with five questions designed to test basic digital literacy knowledge among my batchmates. The form includes multiple choice questions (such as identifying phishing attempts and correct password practices) and short answer questions. The responses are automatically collected in a linked Google Sheet, which makes it easy to analyse results. This task made me understand how Google Workspace tools — Forms, Sheets, Docs, and Drive — can be combined to build simple but effective digital solutions for academic and collaborative purposes without writing a single line of code.



Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Module 4 | Marks: 20

Task 4 focused on professional digital communication — specifically email writing and responsible social media behaviour. As a Student Digital Ambassador, one of my core responsibilities is to model and teach these skills to my peers.

I drafted two professional emails as required. The first was an email from a student to a professor requesting an extension on an assignment deadline, following all professional email conventions including a specific subject line, formal greeting, concise and polite body, and a proper sign-off with name and registration number. The second was an email expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity, addressed to a company's internship coordinator. Both emails were written with attention to tone, structure, and language, avoiding any slang or informal phrasing.

I also created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist with five do's (such as keeping profiles professional, using privacy settings, and posting relevant academic achievements) and five don'ts (such as sharing personal location data, posting offensive content, or responding impulsively to negative comments online). One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem is when a student publicly posted frustration about a professor on social media using their college name. The post went viral within the campus network, led to disciplinary action, and damaged the student's academic reputation. This could have been avoided by addressing the concern privately through email or speaking to a counsellor instead.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention Guide

Module 5 | Marks: 20

Task 5 required me to research a real-world cybercrime type, write a detailed case study, and create a prevention checklist tailored for college students in India. I chose UPI and Online Payment Fraud as my topic because it is one of the most common and rapidly growing forms of cybercrime targeting young people in India.

My case study explains how UPI fraud typically happens step by step — beginning with the attacker identifying a target (often someone selling items on platforms like OLX), then making contact, creating a false sense of urgency, and ultimately tricking the victim into entering their UPI PIN to 'receive' money — which actually authorises a debit from their own account. The case study also covers who is typically targeted, the financial and psychological consequences, and references the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline 1930.

What surprised me most during my research was how simple and psychologically clever these scams are. The attackers do not use any sophisticated hacking — they rely entirely on confusion and trust. The single most important fact I learned is that you never need to enter your UPI PIN to receive money. One habit I will personally change as a result of this task is to always verify the identity of anyone contacting me about a payment before taking any action, and to never act under pressure or urgency when money is involved.

Conclusion

This project was a genuinely useful and practical learning experience. Across five tasks, I moved from understanding what digital literacy means to actually practising it — by building real profiles, writing professional emails, creating collaborative tools, and researching cybercrime. Each task reinforced the idea that being digitally literate is not just about knowing how to use technology, but about using it responsibly, professionally, and safely. The GitHub repository I created for this project is itself a part of my growing digital portfolio, and I intend to keep building on it throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal.

References

- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- GitHub Documentation – docs.github.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Workspace Learning Centre – workspace.google.com/learning-center
- Canva Design School – canva.com/learn
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- VIT Bhopal University – vitbhopal.ac.in